SYSTEMS SAVING LIVES
KEY MESSAGES

GUIDELINES 2025
EUROPEAN RESUSCITATION COUNCIL©

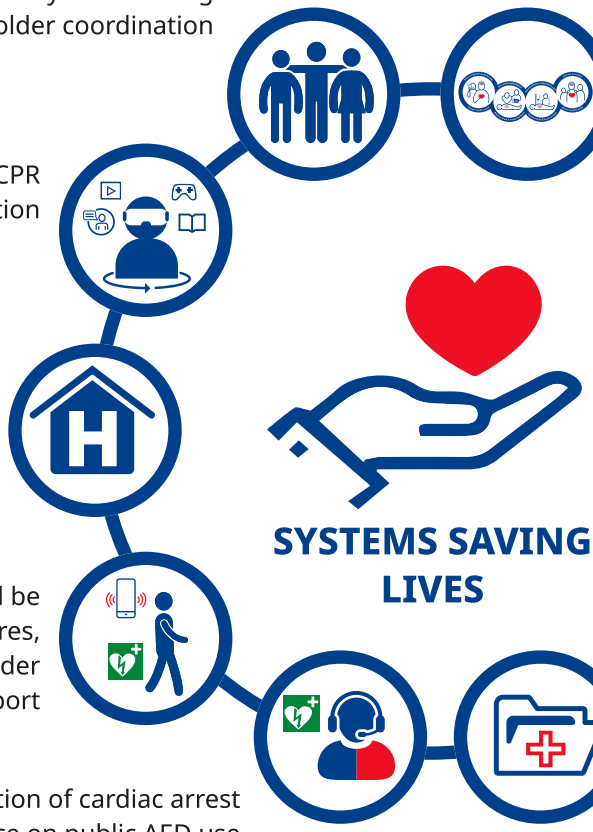
Government leadership is essential - through policy, public campaigns, mandatory CPR training and stakeholder coordination

A simple, four-link Chain of Survival is an effective model to help everyone involved in resuscitation understand life-saving systems

Social media and digital tools can support CPR education and community mobilisation

Resuscitation systems must be tailored to local contexts, using local data and reflecting available resources

Hospitals must support family presence during CPR and establishing referral pathways to cardiac arrest centres. Collaborate with survivor organisations and provide rehabilitation care after discharge to improve quality of life



Community engagement is critical, including CPR training at public events and participation in global campaigns such as World Restart A Heart (WRAH)

First responder systems should be integrated with dispatch centres, prioritising AED accessibility, responder safety and psychological support

School-based CPR education must be mandatory, beginning from age 4 and progressing in complexity, supported by legislation and innovative tools

Early EMS recognition of cardiac arrest and guidance on public AED use are vital for timely intervention

Guidelines and resuscitation systems must be adaptable to local context and resource settings, using local data and cultural insight while clearly reporting the respective setting in research and publications

AED - automatic external defibrillator; CPR - cardiopulmonary resuscitation; EMS - emergency medical services